COLE MASAKI

LEAD DESIGNER / BRAND, CAMPAIGN & DIGITAL DESIGN

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PORTFOLIO **colemasaki.com**

PROFILE

Lead Designer with design experience since 2019 spanning licensed entertainment IP, premium merchandise, large-scale campaigns and e-commerce. Leads projects from concept through print-ready production and launch, combining hands-on creative direction with web development and international partner coordination.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent / Freelance / Designer & Web Developer — **2019–Present**

Project-based since 2019; full-time independent practice since June 2026.

- Delivered visual identities, logo and album artwork, and promotional campaigns for clients; created recurring marketing and social creative for SNPIT, a camera-based photo-battle app.
- Designed and developed bilingual client websites using WordPress, plus a design-services website built with Next.js and Vercel.

Tokyo Dub Agent / Lead Designer — **2023–2026**

- Led visual direction and hands-on execution across company and affiliated-brand websites, licensed merchandise, promotional campaigns, retail signage and live events.
- Designed and built 3 websites: Tokyo Dub Agent, AKIBA 観光協議会 (Akihabara Tourism Organization) and AKIHABARA PREMIUM COLLECTION, including a Shopify e-commerce storefront.
- Directed premium-collectible and campaign graphics for IP collaborations including Attack on Titan, Ghost in the Shell, Cowboy Bebop, Madoka Magica, Chainsaw Man and Baki.
- Led design for every AKIBA EDEN LOT collection during tenure: original merchandise layouts and graphics, print-ready production files, promotional cover images and backgrounds; titles included Monogatari Series, STEINS;GATE, Zegapain STA and New Panty & Stocking with Garterbelt.
- Created posters, banners, in-store visuals and event creative for 25+ Akihabara campaigns, including the 100-store Hatsune Miku festival, NIKKE and Wuthering Waves, plus Akihabara International Film Festival.
- Contributed to merchandise revenue and expansion of the company's licensed-IP portfolio by delivering production-ready assets and coordinating approvals with licensors, vendors and overseas partners.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE / CONTINUED

Decoded Japan / Lead Designer — 2022–2023

- Led visual design for a collectible-wine NFT venture that produced 150,000+ generative images; created web, product-facing and promotional assets.
- Produced brand and digital materials for Tapestry, a separate founder-led venture, working with its established corporate identity system.
- Designed websites, social and campaign graphics, and motion assets across multiple initiatives, maintaining consistency between channels.

AnimeX Japan / Graphic Designer — 2019–2021

- Created banners, icons, promotional graphics and interface assets for online gaming platforms, collaborating with developers on cohesive user-facing designs.

SELECTED INDEPENDENT PROJECT

Wheels of Steel — Independent Game Project (2026)

Developed a stylized 3D Unity game, creating its visual direction, interface and Steam promotional assets.

CORE SKILLS

Design: Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe After Effects, Blender; brand identity, art direction, licensed merchandise, prepress/print production, campaign design and motion.

Web & technical: WordPress, Shopify, HTML/CSS, Next.js, Vercel, Unity, C#; website design and responsive implementation.

Languages: English (native); Japanese (conversational).

EDUCATION

Parsons School of Design, New York — Attended (no degree)

University of British Columbia — One year of study

Christian Academy in Japan — High school graduate